

Research Methods for IT Professionals

WEEK 6, DATA COLLECTION

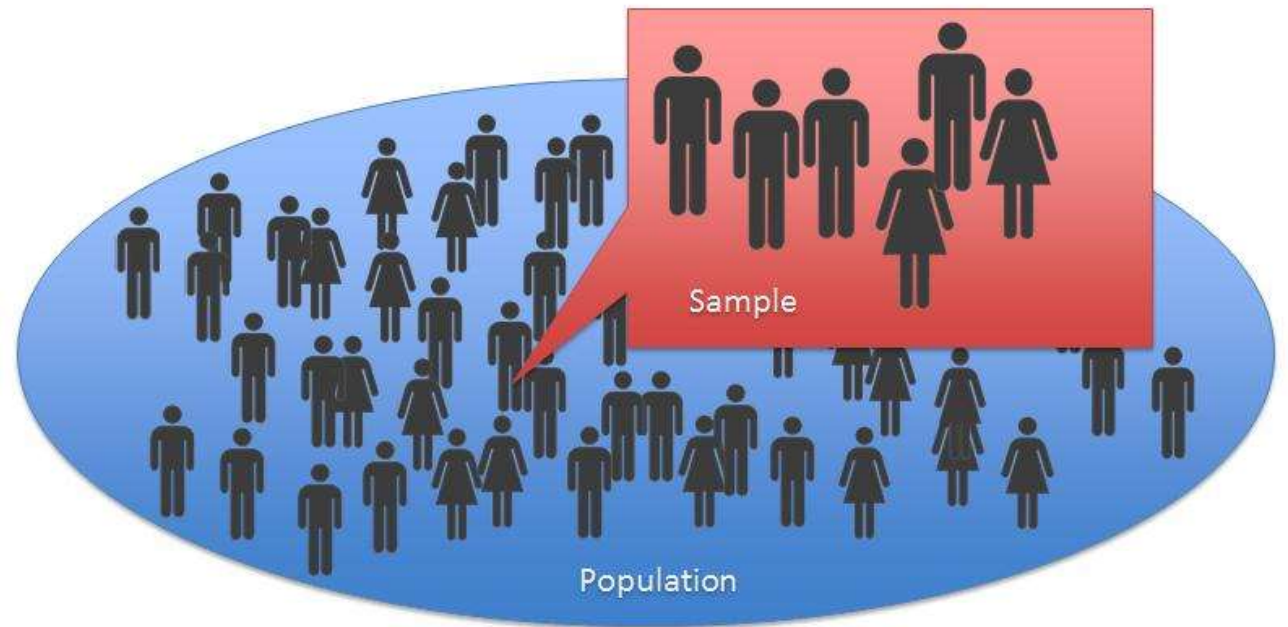
SAMPLING

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What is sampling?

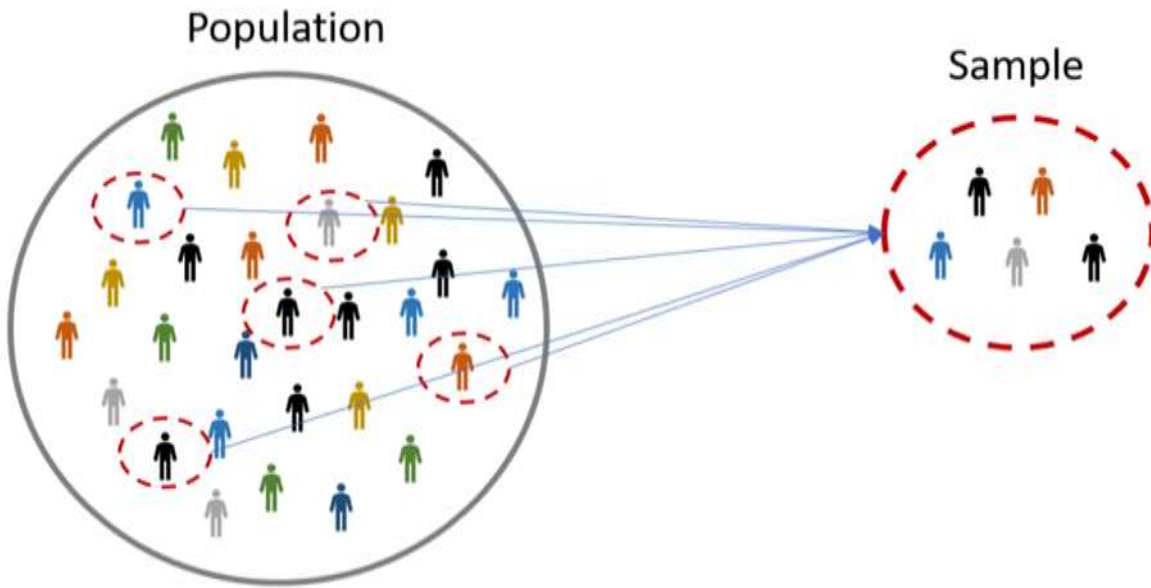
A selection of a subset of a population for inclusion in a study (Daniel, 2012:1)

Sampling...is the process of selecting a few (a sample) from a bigger group (the sampling population) to become the basis of estimating or predicting the prevalence of an unknown piece of information, situation or outcome regarding the bigger group. A sample is a subgroup of the population you are interested in. (Kumar, 2011)



Key words

- population
- sample
- sample size
- sampling strategy
- saturation point



Significance of sampling

DONE WELL

- Save money, time, effort
- Provides valid, reliable results

DONE POORLY

- study has little scientific or practical value
- validity and generalisability concerns

Sampling: Quants vs Qual research

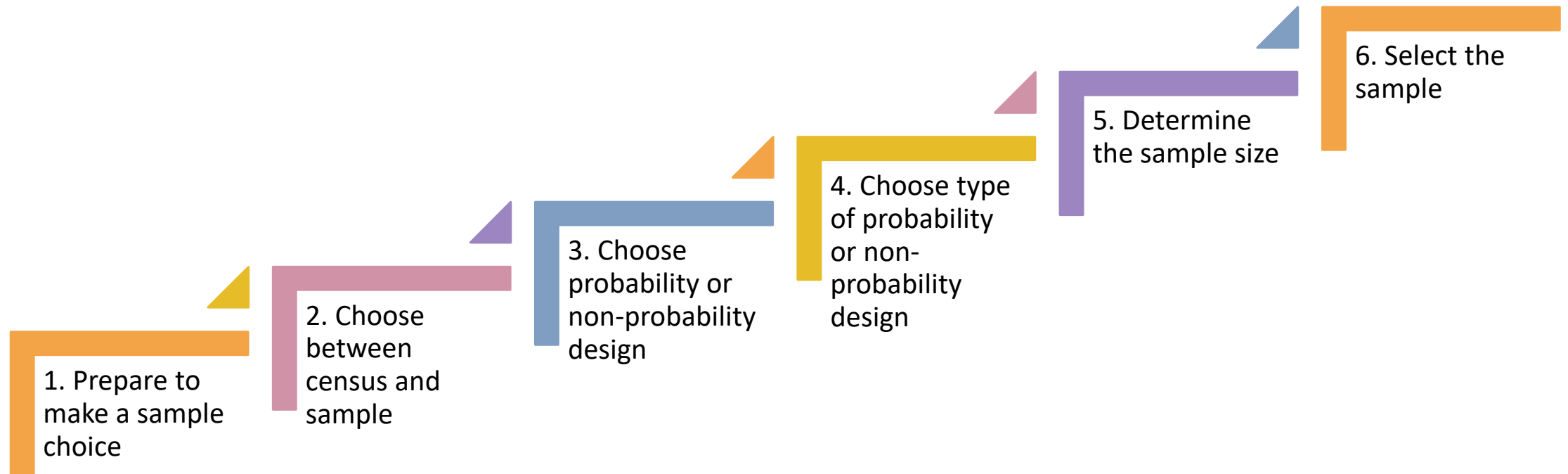
Quants

- attempt to select sample in way that is unbiased
- draw inferences about group from which sample is drawn
- aim for generalisability from sample to larger population
- predetermined sample size, significance and importance attached to sample size
- reduce bias – primarily through randomisation
- probability and non-probability sampling can be used

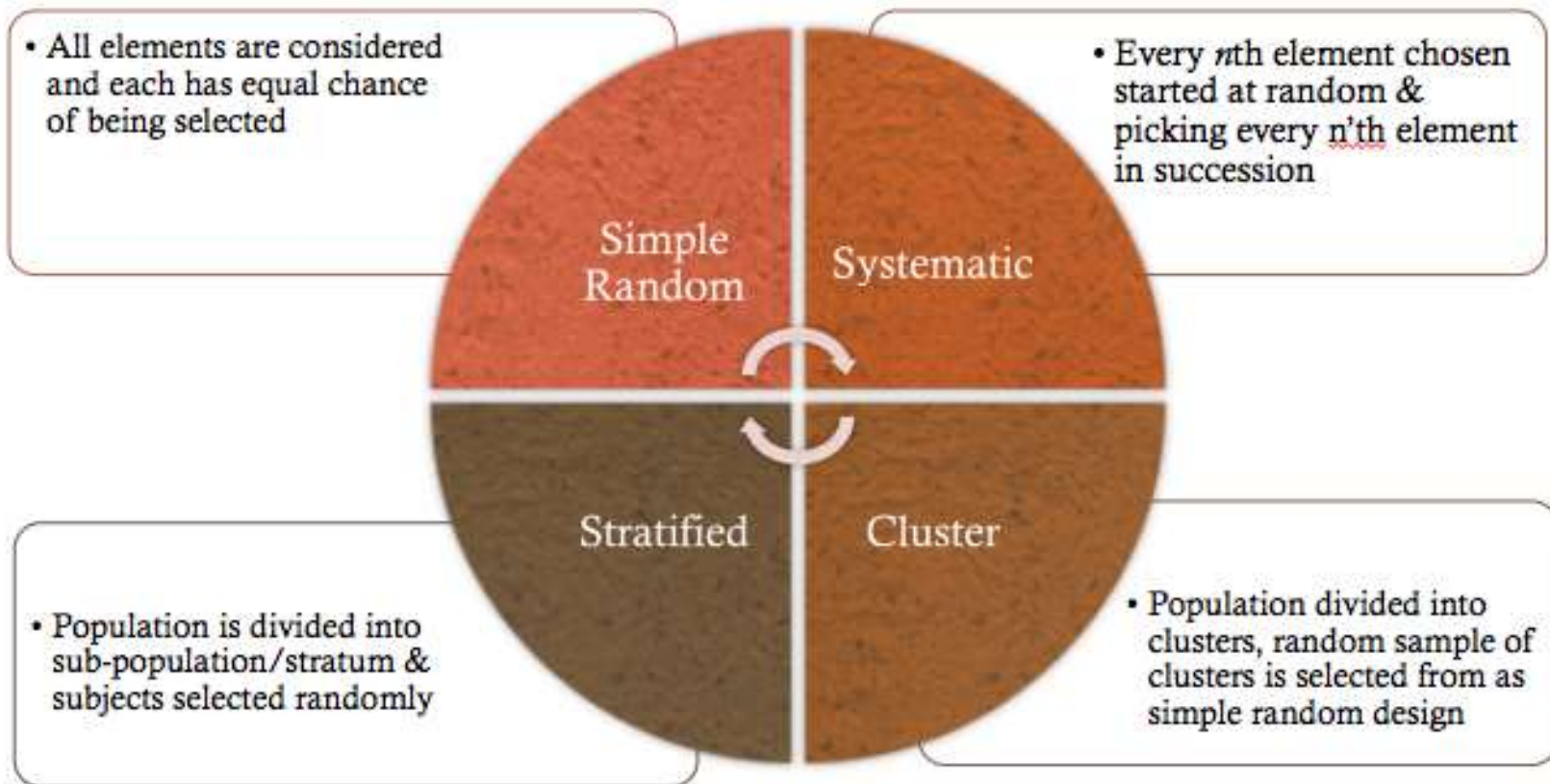
Qual

- number of factors can be considered
 - Access to potential respondents
 - Knowledge of respondents
 - Selecting sample that is typical or different
- aim to gain in-depth knowledge about situation/event/phenomena
- sample isn't predetermined – data saturation more important
- sample size isn't always significant
- non-probability sampling

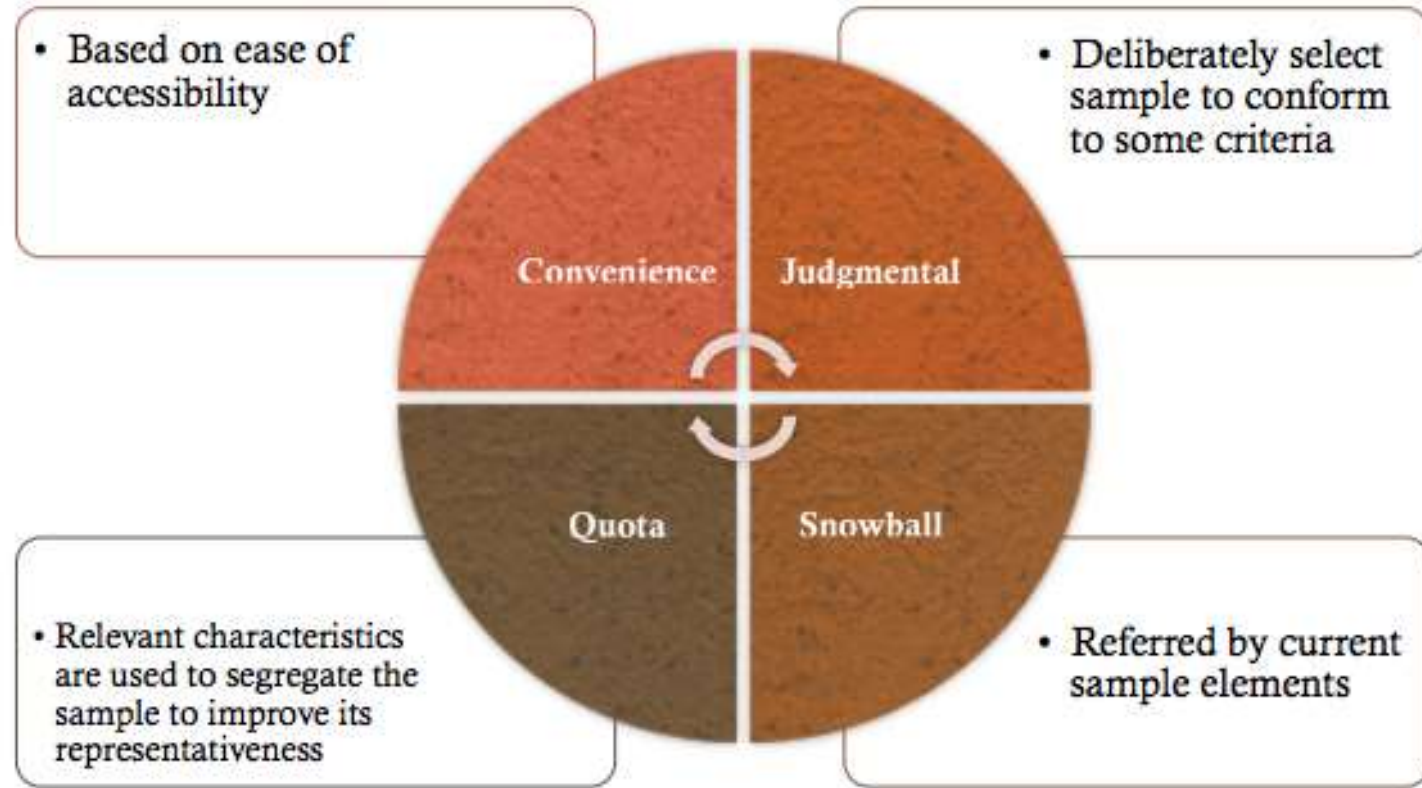
Major steps in sampling process



Probability Sampling



Non-Probability Methods



What makes a good sample

- size of your sample
 - different rules for QUANTS and QUAL research
 - QUANTs (level of confidence of results, degree of accuracy, variance)
 - QUAL (established recommended amount of respondents to yield plausible and credible data)
- heterogeneity (diversity)
 - larger sample size to reach saturation point
- homogeneity (similarities)
 - smaller sample size
- access to population

